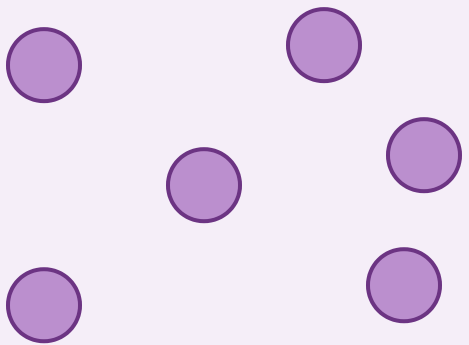
How are the particles of matter arranged?

Isolated atoms

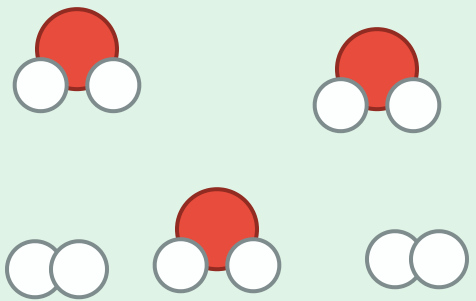
atoms on their own



Only the **noble gases**: helium (He), neon (Ne)…

Molecules

small groups of joined atoms

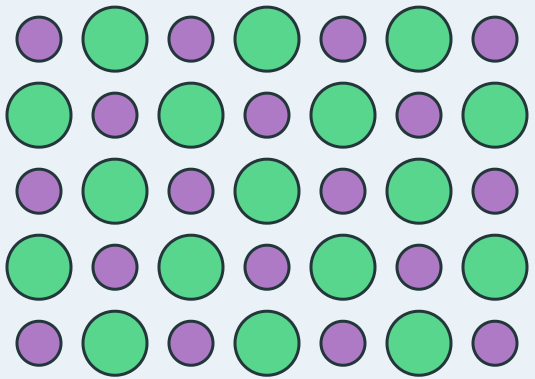


H_2O and H_2 molecules

Simple: H_2, O_2, O_3 · Compounds: H_2O, CO_2

Crystals

millions of atoms in order



NaCl crystal: Na^+ (purple) and Cl^- (green)

Simple: diamond (C) · Compounds: salt (NaCl)